



[3.2] - Time limited worlds balancing Intentions.

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Introduction

Time-Limited Worlds Balancing — TLDR

What this doc is about

- We're defining the balancing intentions for the World Rush feature (time-limited events), covering difficulty, rewards, progression, and monetization.

Core design principles

- Events start at the player's current difficulty level.
- The first rewards are deliberately easy to reach, to hook the player in. Difficulty and reward thresholds scale up from there.
- Modifiers and restrictions create variety: early on they play to the player's strengths; later, they become real strategic challenges that push the player to experiment.

World structure

- Events can be 1, 3 or 5 worlds.
 - Events have up to 5 worlds of increasing difficulty (Easy → Extreme), each with an XP multiplier (×1 up to ×16) to incentivize progression rather than farming the first world indefinitely.

Player profiles & expected engagement

- 4 player types are defined: Light (15 min/day), Regular (45 min), Invested (75 min), Elite (120+ min).
- Each profile has a target outcome: Light players reach the first reward tier, Elite players compete for the leaderboard top.

Reward logic

- Rewards are calibrated to time spent: the baseline is ~62 HC/minute of play.
- Leaderboard rewards are additive on top (5% bonus for Light up to 90% for 1st place), meaning hardcore players can earn ~168% of base rewards.

Rebloom mechanic

- The map "reblooms" (resets) automatically every X hours to encourage multiple short sessions rather than one long grind.
- Only Invested and Elite players are expected to buy rebloom — Light and Regular players rely on the free auto-rebloom.

In-event elements (treasures, quests, wheels...)

- All in-event elements (quests, treasure chests, fortune wheels, etc.) are converted to `event_xp` using the same HC value as the main world, multiplied by the world multiplier.

Open questions / WIP

- UI/UX, Remote Settings, and FTUE sections are not written yet.
- A strategic discussion is needed on whether to redistribute ~20% of main world rewards toward events — this would affect the overall economy balance.

References

▼ Pocket Champs

▼ Learnings Pocket Champs

How does it work?

Events in Pocket are solutions to problems. When you're stuck on the main road, you go run an event — it can unblock you. (macro level)

The balancing on this has been done in such a way that the first rewards can be collected easily (it's common to clear the first 3 races without thinking too much about it). (micro level)

Then it gets harder to push further.

The restrictions force the player to opt for a different strategy: "I'd normally use the overboard, but since I'm not allowed, I'll try the jetpack."

The modifiers offer strategic decisions: "I can see it's 2/3 swim and 1/3 climb, but actually, since my gorilla is heavily boosted by the modifier whereas my mermaid potion isn't, I'll take the gorilla."

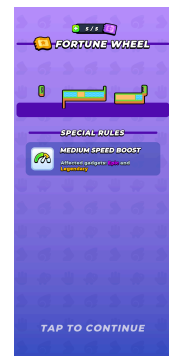
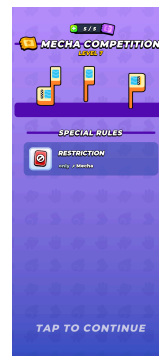
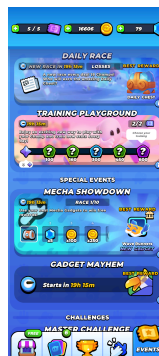
This balancing means that the game as a whole offers paths of challenges. The difficulty is: "with the resources I have, where do I put them to make it through everything?"

You have the **Tactical/Strategic** dichotomy with **Choosing the right gadget/Understanding the strengths and weaknesses of our character and gear, and spending time and tickets only where it's relevant.**

In Pocket, it makes complete sense that events represent real challenges in their own right. We can reasonably consider that the side activities are part of the core loop.

Additionally, these modifiers and restrictions give value to most of the gadgets.

- The rewards are interesting, more so than the trophy road.
 - Moreover, since tickets are given out very frequently, it's a missed opportunity not to use the events to train your champ.
 - However, the player session can't stretch on forever, so we'll observe a split rather than an addition (at least, not entirely additive).
- Unlike the main road races, events don't give training bags, but they give better rewards on victory.
 - So we can extract something like:
 - "We challenge players on similar difficulties, but we only reward them when they succeed."
 - "We reward better, but not insanely high quantities either (we could reward way more if we were



certain it was purely adding to the player session."

I have to decide where to put my play time. The rewards are tuned for that — I don't lose anything by choosing one mode over another. It's purely a strategic question.

▼ Golds and Gobelins

▼ Second World rewards

- In the second event, there is a duplicated version of everything (Potions, coins, cards, upgrade)

▼ Restart from zero

When the player launches the event, they start over from 0.

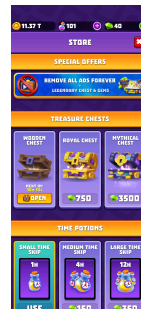
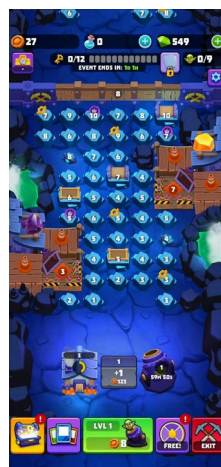
This isn't a problem because the main gameplay is idle anyway, so it's fine for the player to launch the second world. It farms on its own, and in the second world, you can go super fast by redoing the adventure but in fast-forward.

You also get blocked faster.

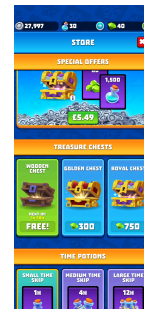
This world is, in a way, a "fast" version of the game.

The fact that the game restarts allows you to choose different strategies — for example, upgrading certain cards and not others.

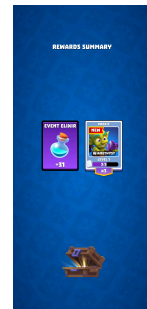
Starting over from 0, when the core loop is fun, is engaging for the player. It allows you to take different paths, to experiment, and to learn the game in depth.



In my main world shop, I collected my free reward's chest in the store.



In my event store, I can collect new chest that contains different stuff.

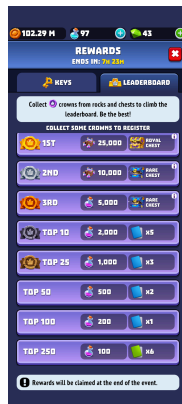


▼ Leaderboard

There's a leaderboard that allows the most engaged players to position themselves in competition and earn resources.

It's of course artificial (full bots).

In a competitive situation, this allows players who are behind on the leaderboard to come back into the game at least for the duration of the event.



▼ AFK Journey

I should specify here that AFK Journey isn't a big-scale game, so our attention to its systems should be tempered accordingly. My opinion on that is that it's not clear to the player what are the differences from one character to another, you make your team based on aesthetics rather than based on strategy, when the game becomes grindy, power driven players tend to flee.

▼ Raid Treasure & Season Legend Trial

Two kind of TLE: **Raid Treasure** and **Season Legend**

The Raid Treasure

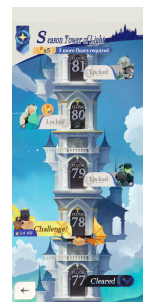
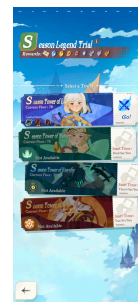
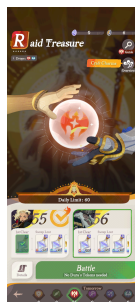
It's a combat mode in which you can only use characters of a certain role.

It's a progress path with a skip (skip the fights in which there's too big a power delta) and a sweep (collect the rewards from passed fights in exchange for tickets).

The rewards are there to reward the characters of the role being used (they're used to craft equipment that can only be used on characters of that role).

We challenge on A, and we reward on A.

The feature depends on the days of the week, with a one-day shift so you get: "Monday: tank, Tuesday: wizard, Wednesday: rogue..." and the following week



"Tuesday: tank, Wednesday: wizard, Thursday: rogue..."

The Season Legend Trial

It's a combat mode in which you're only allowed to use characters of a certain race.

You earn exclusive resources there to level up your characters to max level.

We challenge on Collection, and we reward on Power

What I take from this idea is that in Scroll, we can challenge the player on biomes and still reward them on specific rewards that they want.

The feature depends on the days of the week: *"Monday it's the blues, Tuesday it's the reds, Wednesday the greens, Thursday the greys, Friday it's the reds AND the blues, Saturday the greys AND the greens, Sunday it's everyone."*

Intentions

A. As a player,

1. I want to have a fresh experience with game rules that differs from what I'm usually used to, and **be rewarded for it.** (restriction/modifier)
2. I want to be rewarded **at the height of my engagement.**

B. As a game maker,

1. I want to maintain the player's interest by offering them a refreshed experience (retention) (restriction/modifier).
2. I want to create new monetization opportunities for the game.

Feature

To fit our intentions, we want to have the Time Limited Event to be balanced in a certain way, I'm proposing in the "Dynamic Worlds" drop down a balancing. I call them "Dynamic Worlds" because their difficulty is dynamic and depend on the player.

▼ Dynamic worlds

I set them as "when you start it, it is at the level of your current world"

▼ Difficulty

On a macro level, a TLE is at the level of the player.

On a more micro level, a TLE has a difficulty ramp-up over the course of which players will have more or less trouble farming their resources.

- Rewards

The reward gauges are part of the difficulty and therefore have to follow a similar logic at the exception of the first rewards. The first rewards needs to be good to drag the player inside the event.

▼ From world to world progression

We will add an **event_xp multiplier** from worlds to worlds to incentivize the player to progress from worlds to worlds and not stay in the same first easy world.

- About quests

I want the quest difficulty to follow the difficulty trend of the rest of the world. We already have the support for the difficulty of quests, we can use this system. (*Intention A. 2. "I want to be rewarded **at the height of my engagement.**"*)

World	Difficulty philosophy	Time to collect for an Engaged	XP
First World	Easy to complete (previous world difficulty)	2 seconds (+10 Δ)	x1
Second World	Normal Difficulty (current world difficulty)	5 seconds (0 Δ)	x2
Third World	Hard Difficulty (next world difficulty)	20 seconds (-50 Δ)	x4

World	Difficulty	Time to collect for an Engaged	XP
First World	Easy to complete (previous world difficulty)	2 seconds (floor value +10 Δ)	x1
Second World	Normal Difficulty	5 seconds (0 Δ)	x2
Third World	Hard	20 seconds (-50 Δ)	x4
Fourth World	Very Hard	35 seconds (-100 Δ)	x8
Fifth World	Extreme	50 seconds (-150 Δ)	x16

▼ Modifiers/Restriction

Event difficulty will be tuned to welcome the player in and let them finish each event at the start. Then, once we estimate they've learned the ropes, we'll switch them over to the real difficulty.

[3.2] Modifier and restrictions

This logic will layer on top of the modifiers:

- The first levels will have modifiers that play to the player's strengths — modifiers that reward their choices.
 - In the early levels, the modifiers will be there to genuinely help the player.
- Later, restrictions and modifiers will start to challenge the player on their collection and power.
 - At that point, modifiers will be integrated into the power calculation and factored into how difficulty is set.

The logic for the restrictions will be:

- Making the player discover additional ways to complete a given challenge (restricting natural choices).

▼ Balancing

A note on the numbers. In the "Progression" tab, I can see that the intentions plan for the player to complete 12 quests per day. A Light completes half of that, and an Invested completes much more. (Respecting the playtime ratios, that gives us 1, 4, 12, 24.)

The problem with this is that the first reward steps need to require very little XP to complete. Either way, the rewards progression can't be linear.

▼ Rebloom mechanic:

- I understood that the intent behind the "rebloom" mechanic is to limit how long players engage with the feature in a single session.
- The reboot happens every X amount of time (the example given is 2 hours).
 - I interpret that as: "We want the player to come back multiple times rather than play one long session."

We can have the approach of “players are going to clear one biome entirely and maybe come back for the rebloom”

Engagement behavior	Base daily playtime	Expected daily time in event	Number of quests done by day	Split (% of xp from quest)	Buy the “rebloom” ?	Example of expected progression
Light	30	15	6	90%	No	First reward of the gauge or first world rewards if multiple worlds
Regular	60	45	12	75%	No	Good medium of the gauge or few worlds rewards if multiple worlds
Invested	100	75	16	60%	Sometimes	Final gauge reward or final world reward if multiple worlds
Elite	180	120+	24	45%	Yes	Final leaderboard reward

▼ Balancing Approaches

▼ Quests balancing approach:

Quests are a major source of XP in the main worlds, and we're going to carry that logic over into the TLEs.

The same way as in Golds and Goblins, we want the player to be heavily rewarded in the first minutes of play within the event — the event's first quests should be very easy to collect.

Then, we want them to be harder.

▼ Rebloom Limitation balancing approach

- **Light** players will clear half the map and not come back.
- **Regular** players will clear the map, and occasionally come back to reclear it (waiting for the **auto-rebloom**), but won't use **solid rebloom** (opportunistic gameplay).
- **Invested** players will clear the map and be serious about refreshes ("I know I need to come back in a few hours"). They'll also be willing to spend a few **reblooms** to catch up from time to time (I missed a cycle, but I still want the final reward).
- **Elite** players will clear everything, often, and will pay whatever it takes to get the leaderboard rewards (within the limits set out in the table above).

▼ Based on those two ways to approaching the problem, we can think about few first great ideas for this problem:

1. Completing the first quest should give the first reward (never less than one, and probably the only times it's just one are in the first events). The portion of that tier should be reachable through **small** resources.
2. So I can set it up so that clearing some of the map and one of the quests brings in enough event_xp to unlock the first threshold (first reward).
3. Then, I can set it up so that every time you come back to the event after a rebloom and clear half of the map + do the quests, you gain one threshold.
4. Then, I can set it up so that the further you progress in event levels, the more the number of rewards increases. Up to a limit for UX reasons, and from that point on, the difficulty of clearing the map starts to increase.
5. Then, I can set things up to create bots to simulate a leaderboard.

▼ The leaderboard will need to be set up in such a way that the bots challenge the player so that they become first on the leaderboard once the full number of hours planned for an event has elapsed (in this case 2h, equivalent to logging in 12 times).

The leaderboard will be divided in different player type.

▼ Rewards

The logic for the reward is “We are going to give you in terms of currency what you have spent time wise”

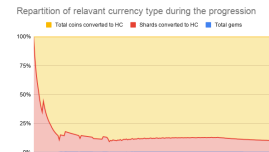
▼ In facts, right now, we can find this value in our simulator

We can see that the value converge towards **62HC/minute**.

It can be very surprising to see that since after 30 minutes of game, I don't end up with ~3600 gems in my balance.

It is due to the fact that I calculate the value with the maximum value of pet shards (5 HC/ pet shards) and I convert the coins as well. In reality, the pet shards never really costs that much and you always will find discounted some way or another and the coins are not really that valuable either.

You can also see that most of the income is via coins and pet shards.



Engagement behavior	Leaderboard	Leaderboard reward percentage	Leaderboard Reward	Non-Leaderboard Reward	Amount of the event_rewards
Light	Top 75%	5%	62 HC * 15 minutes * nb of days of the event (1 to 3 days) * 5%	62 HC * 15 minutes * nb of days of the event (1 to 3 days)	~5,25% of the event rewards
Regular	Top 50%	25%	62 HC * 45 minutes * nb of days of the event (1 to 3 days) * 25%	62 HC * 45 minutes * nb of days of the event (1 to 3 days)	~25% of the event rewards
Invested	Top 25%	30%	62 HC * 75 minutes * nb of days of the event (1 to 3 days) * 30%	62 HC * 75 minutes * nb of days of the event (1 to 3 days)	~78% of the event rewards
Elite	Top 15%	60%	62 HC * 80 minutes * nb of days of the event (1 to 3 days) * 60%	62 HC * 75 minutes * nb of days of the event (1 to 3 days)	~102% of the event rewards
Bronze	3rd place (Top 8%)	70%	62 HC * 85 minutes * nb of	62 HC * 75 minutes * nb of	~116% of the event rewards

			days of the event (1 to 3 days) * 70%	days of the event (1 to 3 days)	
Silver	2dn place (Top 4%)	80%	62 HC * 120 minutes * nb of days of the event (1 to 3 days) * 80%	62 HC * 75 minutes * nb of days of the event (1 to 3 days)	~140% of the event rewards
Gold	1st place (Top 1%)	90%	62 HC * 150 minutes * nb of days of the event (1 to 3 days) * 90%	62 HC * 75 minutes * nb of days of the event (1 to 3 days)	~168% of the event rewards

About other elements (treasures, fortune wheels, quests, golden apples...)

The balancing for those elements needs to be the same as for the main world but, converted on XP for a percentage that I will set.

To balance it, I want to calculate the value in HC of a point of event_xp. I think this is equal to the value of main_world_xp (0.1), it will need to be iterated.

Element	What it gives in the main world	What it gives in the TLE	Comments on the amount	Average on main world (HC converted)	In TLE (XP converted)
Quest	Eggs, Coins, XP	event_xp	straight conversion with the multiplier	~144 HC	1440 event_xp * multiplier
Ressources	Coins, XP	event_xp	event_xp = XP with the multiplier		main_world value * multiplier
Treasure	Potions, Eggs, Coins, Gems	Potions, event_xp, Gems	straight conversion	~ 50 HC	500 event_xp * multiplier
Wheel of fortune	Eggs, Potions, Coins, Gems	Potions, event_xp, Gems	straight conversion	~ 32.8 HC	328 event_xp * multiplier
GPE	Potions, Eggs, Coins, XP	event_xp	straight conversion	~ 33 HC	330 event_xp * multiplier
<i>Golden Apple</i>	Eggs, Coins, XP, Potions	Potions, event_xp	straight conversion	~ 18.5 HC	185 event_xp * multiplier

[3.2] Time limited worlds

UI/UX

[...]

Remote settings

FTUE

Related docs

V1 - Time limited world battle-plan